

Cassava cyanogenic glycosides: importance, toxicity, and dosage methods

Author links open overlay panelMarney Pascoli Cereda ¹, Suzan Pantaroto de Vasconcellos ²

Show more

Outline

Share

Cite

<https://doi.org/10.1016/B978-0-323-90057-7.00014-0>Get rights and content

Abstract

Cassava is a crop adapted to the region of 20 degrees above and below the equator line. Its roots and leaves are widely used as [staple food](#), regional foods, and refined cuisine and is of cultural importance in many countries. The dissemination of the culinary use of cassava (roots and leaves) is held back by the known presence of cyanogenic compounds. Their effect on consumer health is a major concern, which can be perceived in articles from many researchers. However, South American consumers do not share the concern that can be attributed to the rarity of proven cases of contamination. Research explains how to reduce the content of free cyanides, how they are distributed in the cassava plant, which portions potentially cause human intoxication, and which mechanisms are responsible for an efficient [detoxification](#). The concern for African consumers can be explained by the still-existing problems of food insecurity. In contrast, South American consumers consume cassava roots and leaves, cooked and fermented, as well as its by-products, within the confines of their traditional cuisine and do not register problems related to cyanogenic compounds. Importance of cyanogenic compounds for human health is the focus of this chapter that also highlights the difficulties with the analysis methods.